Gemini Notebook

Product Requirement Document [PRD]

Title	NotebookLM
Date & Version	14th July, 2026. V1
Product - Point of Contact (POC)	Manish Verma
Design POC	
Tech POC	
Marketing POC	

Objective

1. **Business**:

- Improve 30-day retention by 5–10% within 6 months by delivering more relevant and personalized research outputs.
- Increase user engagement by reducing the need to repeatedly refine prompts or switch to external AI tools.
- Strengthen NotebookLM's position as the preferred AI-powered research assistant for students, researchers, and knowledge workers.
- Increase adoption of advanced AI capabilities by making research outputs more contextual and intent-aware.

2. **Users**:

1. Help users receive research outputs tailored to their specific goal without repeatedly rewriting prompts.
2. Reduce the effort required to refine AI responses.
3. Improve the relevance, depth, and usefulness of AI-generated summaries.
4. Enable users to complete more of their research within NotebookLM instead of switching to other AI tools.

How do we measure success?

Goal: Increase user retention by delivering relevant and personalized research outputs that reduce the need for prompt refinement and external tools.

Success Metrics:

Key Metric:
30-Day Retention Rate - Percentage of users who return to NotebookLM within 30 days after

using Research Modes.

Secondary Metrics

- Research Mode Adoption Rate
- Percentage of research sessions where users select a research mode before asking a question.
- Response Satisfaction Rate
- Percentage of AI responses marked as helpful.
- Prompt Refinement Rate
- Average number of prompt edits or regenerations before users obtain a satisfactory answer.

3. **Guardrails:**

- Response Generation Time
- Citation Accuracy Rate
- Session Completion Rate

Who are the Users?

Primary Persona: Knowledge Worker

Age: 20–45

Role: Students, researchers, consultants, product managers, analysts

Context: Uses NotebookLM to understand and synthesize information from multiple documents.

Environment: Desktop-first research sessions involving PDFs, reports, notes, and articles.

Problems we are solving

Core Need

- Users need AI-generated research outputs that match their specific research intent without requiring repeated prompt refinement.

Problems

- AI responses are often too generic for different research goals.
- Users repeatedly edit prompts to get the desired output.
- Users leave NotebookLM to continue their research using other AI tools.
- Users spend additional effort reorganizing AI-generated information.

Jobs To Be Done (JTBD)

- **Functional Job**

  When I'm researching a topic, I want NotebookLM to understand my objective and generate outputs tailored to that goal so I can complete my work faster.

- **Emotional Job**

  I want confidence that the AI understands what I'm trying to accomplish and provides useful responses the first time.

- **Social Job**

I want to confidently share accurate, well-structured research outputs with classmates, colleagues, or stakeholders.

How do we know these problems exist?

User Survey (8 Responses)

Key Findings

- 62% wanted more personalized AI-generated outputs.
- 50% wanted responses to better match their research queries.
- 50% switched to another AI tool when NotebookLM's responses didn't meet their expectations.
- Many respondents reported refining prompts or regenerating answers before receiving useful results.

c. **Behavioural Signals**

- Users frequently regenerate responses instead of accepting the first answer.
- Users rewrite prompts multiple times to improve output quality.
- Users often continue their research in external AI tools, indicating gaps in NotebookLM's current experience.

Solution

I evaluated multiple solutions using the **RICE framework** (Reach × Impact × Confidence ÷ Effort).

Solution	Reach (1-3)	Impact (1-3)	Confidence (1- 3)	Effort (1-3)	RICE score	Rationale
Research Modes	3	3	3	2	13.5	Personalizes AI responses based on user intent, reducing prompt refinement and improving response relevance.
Prompt Suggestions	3	2	3	1	18	Helps users write better prompts but doesn't improve AI's understanding of research intent.

Connected Insights	2	3	2	3	4	Improves multi-document analysis but addresses a narrower use case.

Selected Solution: Research Modes

Research Modes

Introduce Research Modes, allowing users to specify their research objective before interacting with NotebookLM. Based on the selected mode, NotebookLM adapts its responses, structure, and level of detail to generate more relevant and personalized research outputs.

This reduces the need for repeated prompt refinement and helps users complete their research within NotebookLM instead of switching to external AI tools.

Product flow (Details of the feature/product):

Open Notebook

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Upload Documents

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Select Research Mode

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Ask Research Question

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NotebookLM generates a personalized response

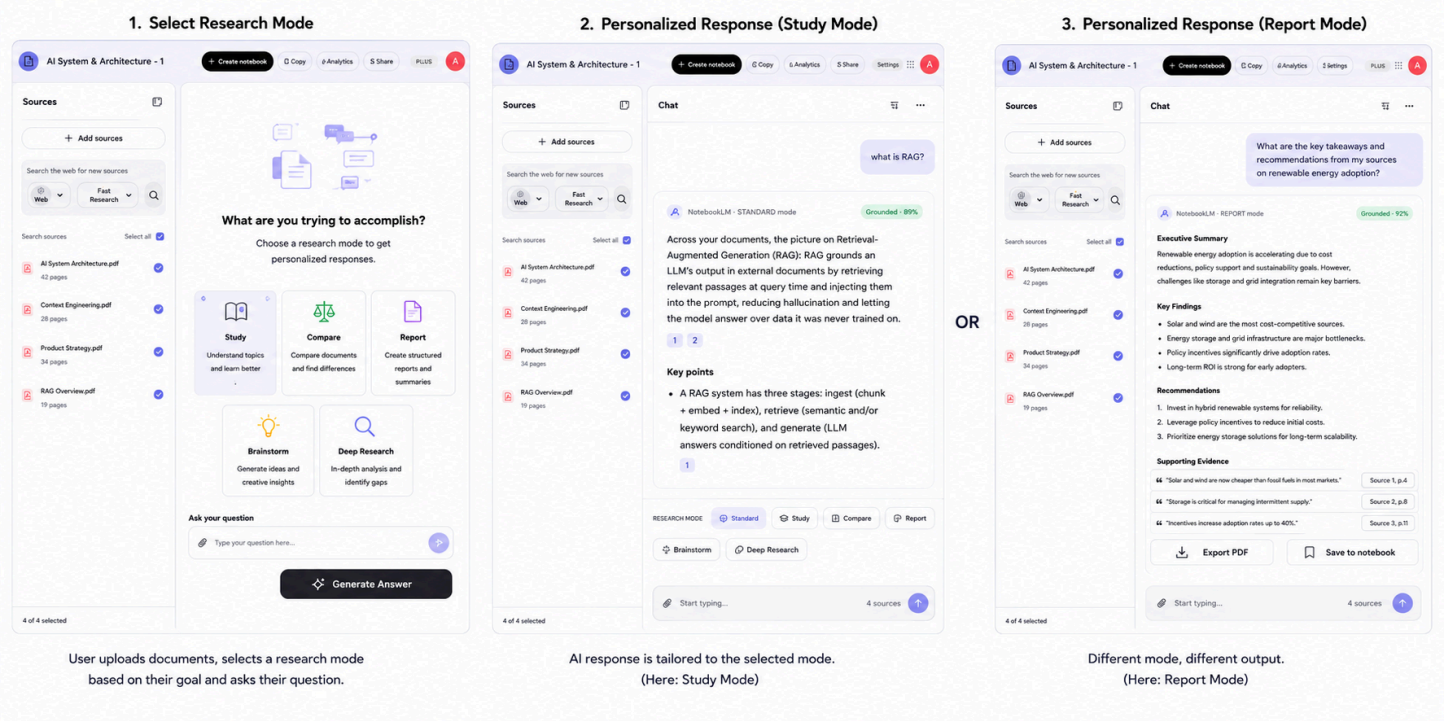
↓

Ask Follow-up Questions / Refine Research

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Save or Export Results

Wireframe



User Stories

Student

- As a student, I want NotebookLM to explain concepts based on my learning goal so that I can understand topics more quickly.

Researcher

- As a researcher, I want NotebookLM to compare multiple documents so that I can identify similarities, differences, and supporting evidence without manually reviewing each source.

Product Manager

- As a product manager, I want NotebookLM to generate structured reports so that I can quickly summarize research for stakeholders.

Consultant

- As a consultant, I want AI responses tailored to my objective so that I spend less time refining prompts.

User acceptance criteria

- Users can select a research mode before asking a question.
- AI responses adapt to the selected research mode.
- Responses include citations from uploaded documents.
- Users can switch research modes during a session.
- Users can save or export generated outputs.

Edge cases

Scenario	Expected Behaviour

No mode selected	Default to Standard mode.
Single document uploaded	Compare mode is disabled with guidance.
Insufficient context	AI requests additional sources or clarifies limitations.

Tentative Timelines:

Task	Date
Leadership approval	01/07/2026
Design ready	14/07/2026
Prototype testing	08/08/2026
Development starts	26/08/2026
Beta Launch	19/12/2026